

Formal Letters

The Basics of Formal Letter Writing



Tips for Writing Formal Letters

- Use of formal tone
- Use of proper language
- Use correct grammar and punctuation
- Use a standard structure
- Proofread

Components of a Formal Letter

1. **Heading:** The heading includes the writer's address, date, and other relevant information.
2. **Date:** Date of writing in DD/MM/YYYY format.
3. **Salutation:** The salutation is the greeting that is used to address the recipient, such as "Dear Mr./Ms./Mrs./Dr."
4. **Body:** The body is the main part of the letter, where the writer expresses their thoughts, ideas, and opinions.
5. **Closing:** The closing is the final part of the letter, where the writer thanks the recipient and signs off, such as "Sincerely" or "Yours faithfully".
6. **Signature:** The signature is the writer's name, which is written at the end of the letter.

Types of Formal Letters:

- Business Letters
- Job Application Letters
- Complaint Letters
- Apology Letters
- Official Letters

Standard Format of a Formal Letter

Your Address

[Your Street Address]
[City, State, ZIP Code]

Date

[Month Day, Year]

Recipient's Address

[Recipient's Name]
[Recipient's Title/Designation]
[Company/Organization Name]
[Street Address]
[City, State, ZIP Code]

Salutation

Dear [Recipient's Title (Mr./Ms./Dr.) Last Name],

Subject

(Subject line, if applicable; optional for some formats)

Body

1. Introduction: State the purpose of your letter clearly in the opening paragraph.
2. Main Content: Provide details, context, or additional information supporting your purpose.
3. Conclusion: End with a summary, call to action, or polite closing remarks.

Cont.

Closing

Yours sincerely,

[Your Full Name]

[Your Job Title (if applicable)]

Signature

(Handwritten signature for hard copies, or typed name for digital letters)

Enclosure:

(Add details of the attached files)

Example

[Your Name]

[Your Address]

[City, State, ZIP Code]

[Email Address]

[Phone Number]

[Date]

[Recipient's Name]

[Recipient's Position]

[Company/Organization Name]

[Company Address]

[City, State, ZIP Code]

Dear [Recipient's Name],

Subject: [Position/Reason for Application]

I hope this letter finds you well. I am writing to formally apply for the [position/job opportunity] at [Company/Organization Name] as advertised [mention where you found the job listing, if applicable]. After reviewing the job description and requirements, I am confident that my qualifications and experiences align with the needs of your team.

Cont.

I hold a [Your Degree/Qualification] in [Field of Study] from [University/Institution Name], and I have [X] years of experience working in [Relevant Industry/Field]. In my previous role at [Previous Company/Organization Name], I [mention key responsibilities or achievements relevant to the position you're applying for].

I am particularly drawn to [Company/Organization Name] because of [mention something specific about the company or its values that appeals to you], and I believe that my skills in [mention relevant skills] would allow me to contribute meaningfully to your team.

Enclosed is my resume for your review. I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss how my skills and experiences align with the requirements of the role. I am available for an interview at your earliest convenience and can be reached at [Your Phone Number] or via email at [Your Email Address].

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the possibility of contributing to [Company/Organization Name] and working with your team.

Sincerely,

[Your Name]

Starting/Opening the letter

- We are writing to inform you that...
 - to confirm...
 - to request...
 - to enquire about...
- I am contacting you for the following reason.
- I recently read/heard about _____ and would like to know...
- Having seen your publication in _____, I would like to...
- I would be interested in (obtaining/receiving)...
- I received your address from _____ and would like to...
- I am writing to inform you about...

Referring to previous contact

- Thank you for your letter of November 13.
- Thank you for contacting us.
- In reply to your request...
- Thank you for your letter regarding...
- With reference to our telephone conversation yesterday...
- Further to our meeting last week...
- It was a pleasure meeting you in Denmark last month.
- I enjoyed having lunch with you last week at the conference.
- I would just like to confirm the main points we discussed at the meeting on Tuesday

Making a request

- We would appreciate it if you would...
- I would be grateful if you could...
- Could you please send me...
- Could you possibly tell us/let us have...
- In addition, I would like to...
- It would be helpful if you could send us...
- I am interested in (obtaining/receiving...)
- I would appreciate your immediate attention to this matter.
- Please let me know what action you propose to take.

Conveying good/bad news

- We are pleased to announce that...
- I am delighted to inform you that...
- You will be pleased to learn that...
- We regret to inform you that...
- I am afraid it would not be possible to...
- Unfortunately we are unable to...
- After careful consideration we have decided (not) to...

Complaining

- I am writing to express my dissatisfaction with...
- I am writing to complain about...
- Please note that _____ has not been supplied.
- We regret to inform you that _____ is now considerably overdue.
- I would like to query the costs incurred, which seem unusually high.

Apologising

- We are sorry for the delay in replying...
- I regret any inconvenience caused
- I would like to apologise for (the delay/the inconvenience)...
- Once again, I apologise for any inconvenience.

Enclosing Documents

- I am enclosing...
- Please find enclosed...
- You will find enclosed...

Referring to future contact

- We look forward to a successful working relationship in the future
- We would be (very) pleased to...
- I would be happy to have an opportunity to
- I look forward to seeing you next week
- Looking forward to hearing from you
- Looking forward to receiving your comments
- I look forward to meeting you on the 13th
- I would appreciate a reply at your earliest convenience.

Closing remarks

- If we can be of any further assistance, please let us know
- If I can help in any way, please do not hesitate to contact me
- If you require more information...
- For further details...
- Thank you for taking this into consideration
- Thank you for your help.
- We hope you are happy with this arrangement.
- We hope you can settle this matter to our satisfaction
- We hope we can settle this matter to your satisfaction

Language

1. Formal:

"I would appreciate it if you could provide detailed information regarding the schedule and requirements for the upcoming workshop. Kindly let me know if any additional steps are required from my side."

Informal:

"Can you send me the details of the workshop schedule? Let me know if I need to do anything else."

2. Formal

"Please accept this letter as my formal notice of resignation from my position as [Job Title] at [Company Name], effective [Last Working Day]. I am grateful for the opportunities I have had to grow professionally during my time here."

Informal:

"I'm writing to let you know that I'm leaving my job at [Company]. My last day will be [Date]. Thanks for everything; it's been a great experience."

3. Formal:

"I am writing to express my dissatisfaction with the product I recently purchased from your store. The item did not meet the described specifications and arrived damaged. I kindly request a replacement or a full refund."

Informal:

"I'm really unhappy with the product I got from you. It's broken, and it's not what I expected. Can I get a refund or a new one?"

4. Formal:

"I am reaching out to request your assistance in reviewing my application for the graduate program. Your insights and feedback would be invaluable to me."

Informal:

"Hey, can you take a look at my application for the grad program? I'd really appreciate your feedback."

Closing Statements

"I look forward to your response at your earliest convenience."

"Please do not hesitate to contact me if you require any further information."

"I would appreciate it if we could schedule a meeting to discuss this further."

"Thank you for your time and consideration."

"I sincerely appreciate your assistance in this matter."

"Thank you for the opportunity to collaborate on this project."

"Should you need any additional details, feel free to reach out to me."

"I remain available for any further clarifications you may require."

"If I can be of any further assistance, please let me know."

"I look forward to hearing from you soon."

"I am eager to discuss this further at your convenience."

"I am hopeful for a positive response."